



2027 eRUPT Academic Research Grants

eBay is trying to solve the most complex problems facing our industry. Strong relationships and collaborations with universities and academic faculty around the world can be a game changer.

eRUPT - eBay's Research and University Partnership for Technology - is excited to offer support and funding for proposals for academic research collaboration projects for 2027. Typical grants provide funds for one year of sponsored research of gift funding, or can be structured as no-fee research projects.

Key Dates

- **Submissions due: September 21, 2026**
- **Winning proposals will be notified in early November**

Successful proposals will answer the following questions:

- Objectives
 - *What are you trying to do? What is the problem? Why is it useful / interesting? Why is it a good candidate for academic research?*
- Previous Work
 - *Describe any relevant previous project and/or publication. If this is the continuation of a project, show previous results (business impact if*

applicable).

- Methodologies / Approaches
 - *How is it done today, and what are the limits of current practice? What is new in your approach and why do you think it will be successful?*
- Impact
 - *How does it relate to the problems eBay is trying to solve? If you are successful, what difference will it make? What applications are enabled as a result?*
- Expected Product / Output
 - *What are the risks? What are the midterm and final checks / metrics for success? (PoC models and algorithms, reports, publications, experiments, learnings...)*
- University / Lab / Researcher Qualification
 - *Who will be the university researchers eBay will engage with? Description of their work, links etc.*
- References

All proposals will be considered, provided they are relevant to eBay and have the potential to advance the state of the art.

eBay is interested in the practical application of the results and expects to, at a minimum, have royalty free license rights to the resulting project IP without additional licensing costs. Open sourcing results under a permissive license may be an option as well depending on the nature of the research.

Please work with your eBay Co-Investigator to submit your proposal.
For any questions, please contact erupt@ebay.com.

In 2025, these collaborations resulted in 22 accepted papers at top-tier conferences such as RecSys, SIGIR, NeurIPS, CVPR, and ICSE.

From previous collaborations:

- [Dr. Constantine Lignos, Brandeis University](#): "Another big part of my research is named entity recognition (NER), which I am also teaching a course on this spring. NER is about finding the "things" in a piece of text, classically people, organizations, and locations. My PhD student [Chester Palen-Michel](#) and I are

collaborating with eBay in applying NER techniques into understanding search queries"

- Dr. Zhengzhong TU, Texas A&M: [ConsID-Gen View-Consistent and Identity-Preserving Image-to-Video Generation](#)
- Dr. Kamesh Madduri, Penn State: [GraphEx: A Graph-based Extraction Method for Advertiser Keyphrase Recommendation](#)